Outlook

Follow-Up on Safety Event Reporting Policy Review and Request for Meeting Record

From Turnage, Kevin D. (IHS/PHX) <Kevin.Turnage@ihs.gov>
Date Thu 22-May-25 16:06
To Pope, Clinton (IHS/PHX/PIMC) <Clinton.Pope@ihs.gov>
Cc McCabe, Endreya (IHS/PHX) <Endreya.McCabe@ihs.gov>; Ward Lund, Debra L. (IHS/PHX) <Debra.Wardlund@ihs.gov>
Bcc Kevin Turnage <kdturnage@protonmail.com>

1 attachment (348 KB)
Memorandum For Record- Revised Review – Safety Event Reporting Policy, Sentinel Event Framework, and Risk Analysis_Signed.pdf;

Dear Mr. Pope,

I am writing to follow up on my revised review of the Safety Event Reporting Policy, this time conducted with full consideration of the associated attachments. While these documents address several operational details, I continue to identify regulatory and structural gaps in the policy itself that, in my professional opinion, remain unresolved.
To be candid, I initially overlooked some content because it was located only in the attachments, which were not integrated into the policy narrative. That fact only reinforces my central concern—that the policy lacks clarity and fails to meet fundamental standards of sound policy development, particularly when judged against applicable regulatory and accreditation requirements.

I understand you have expressed a desire to meet to clarify the issue. However, I believe my position has been consistently and clearly articulated in writing, with specific citations and concrete recommendations for correction. **The concern is not complex: critical safety procedures must be fully embedded in the governing policy, not referenced loosely in supplemental attachments.**

I will meet with you via Microsoft Teams on Tuesday, May 27, 2025, at 11:30 a.m. I have attached my updated policy review for your review ahead of the meeting.

Additionally, I must express that I do not appreciate the continued pattern of my reviews and recommendations being dismissed as either untimely or inappropriate. I offer my assessments in good faith, grounded in current law, regulation, and accreditation standards. These are not personal preferences or theoretical proposals, they are practical recommendations to address clearly identifiable gaps. **When compliance issues are evident, they deserve to be acknowledged and addressed, not deferred or minimized due to organizational discomfort with change.**

As we have discussed previously, I take my role seriously, especially when it involves patient safety. While I respect the complexity of organizational change, I do not accept that "slow" implementation is justifiable when the correction is dictated by a binding regulatory authority. **The idea that the system "cannot handle the change" cannot serve as an excuse for noncompliance.** When compliance

issues are identified, I will continue to advocate for prompt resolution**,** not to be perceived as overzealous, unrealistic, or disruptive.
The truth is, meaningful change is exactly what is needed across IHS if we are to meet the regulatory and ethical responsibilities entrusted to us. Continuing to delay or "kick the can down the road" only deepens our organizational risk and places patients and staff at greater disadvantage.

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Request for Meeting Record:
Given the nature and scope of this discussion, I respectfully request that the Teams meeting be recorded for the purpose of accurate documentation and transcription.
Thank you for your attention to this matter. I look forward to our discussion.

Respectfully,

Kevin D. Turnage, MSN Ed., RN, NE-BC, NHDP-BC, NPD-BC
Policy and Procedure Nurse Consultant
Phoenix Indian Medical Center

Book time with Turnage, Kevin D. (IHS/PHX): Contracting Officer Representative Discussion
Book time with Turnage, Kevin D. (IHS/PHX): Policy Discussion Time

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Book time to meet with me

From: Turnage, Kevin D. (IHS/PHX)
Sent: Thursday, May 22, 2025 14:36
To: Pope, Clinton (IHS/PHX/PIMC) <Clinton.Pope@ihs.gov>
Subject: Tentative: Sentinel Event Memorandum for Record
When: Tuesday, May 27, 2025 10:30 AM-11:30 AM.
Where: Microsoft Teams Meeting